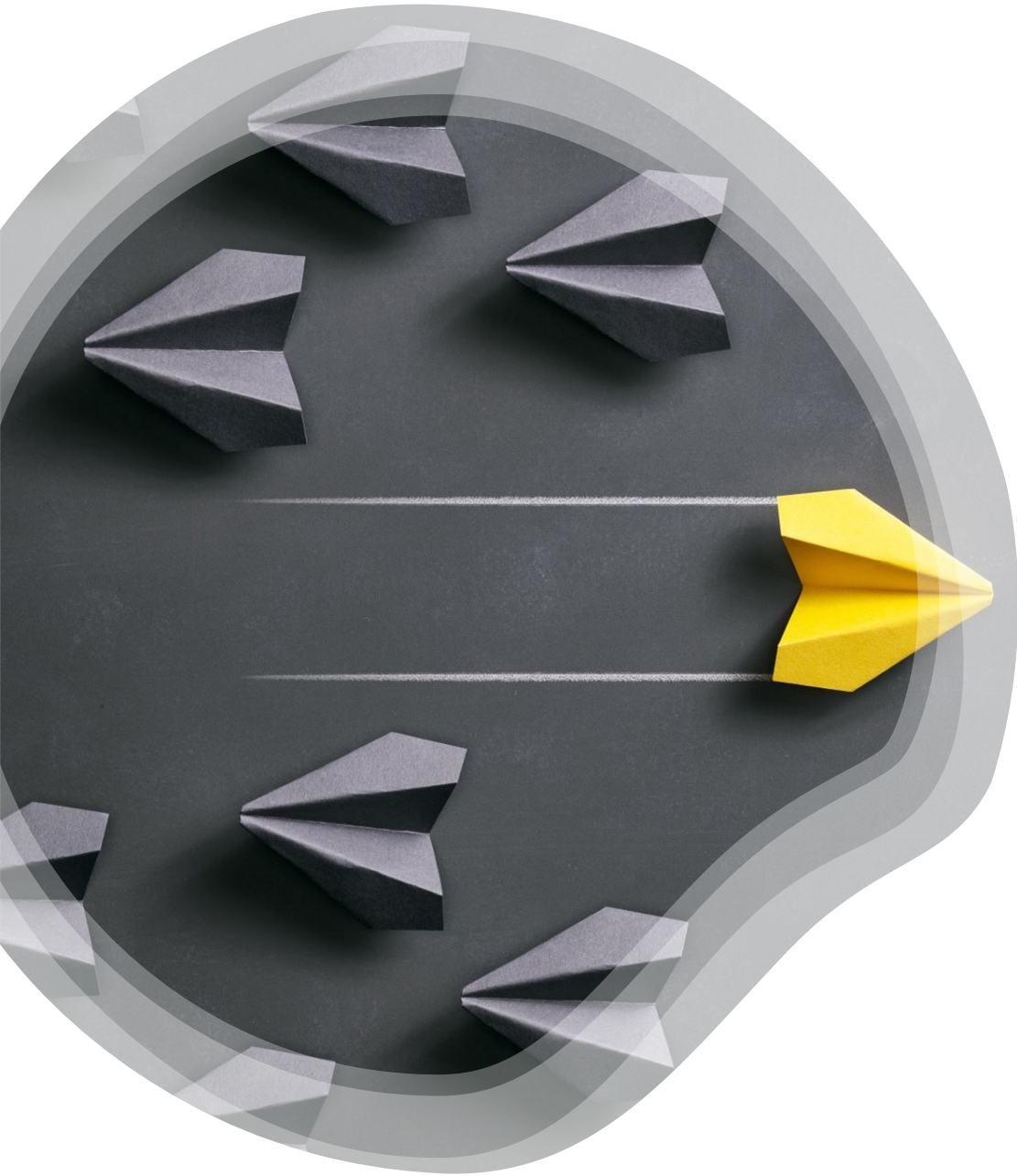




Session V: Career Exploration

Career Development & Career Skills

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

By the end of this section, you will be able to:

- ❖ Describe the stages of career development, and identify the stage you're currently in
- ❖ Identify career development resources in your school, community, and beyond

Desire! That's the one secret
of every man's career

Johnny Carson, entertainer

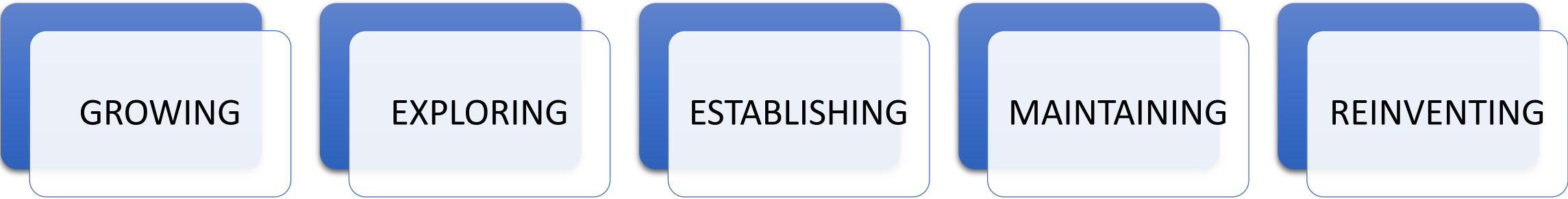




What is Career Development?

- ❖ It's a lifelong process in which we become aware of, interested in, knowledgeable about, and skilled in a career.
- ❖ It's a key part of human development as our identity forms and our life unfolds.

Stages of Career Development



GROWING

EXPLORING

ESTABLISHING

MAINTAINING

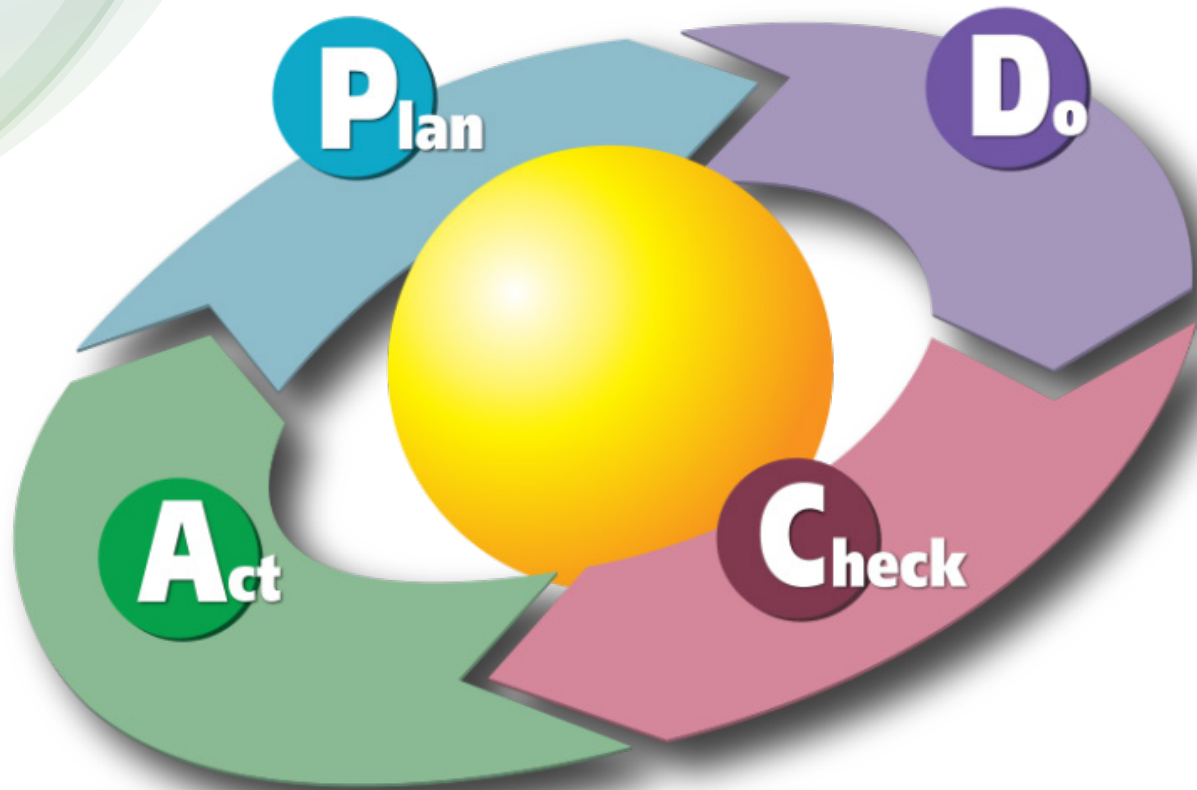
REINVENTING



Career Roadmap

The road map identifies the following four cyclical steps:

1. Know yourself
2. Explore and choose options
3. Gain knowledge and experience
4. Put it all together: the job search process



Plan, Do, Check, Act

PDCA (plan–do–check–act)

- **PLAN:** What are your goals and objectives? What process will you use to get to your targets?
You might want to plan smaller to begin with and test out possible effects.
- **DO:** Implement your plan. Sell your product—which is YOU and your skills, talents, energy, and enthusiasm.
- **CHECK:** Look at your results so far. Are you happy with your job or wherever you are in the career-development process? How is your actual accomplishment measuring up next to your intentions and wishes?
- **ACT:** How should you act going forward? What changes in planning, doing, and checking do you want to take? The PDCA framework is an ongoing process. Keep planning, doing, checking, and acting. The goal is continuous improvement.

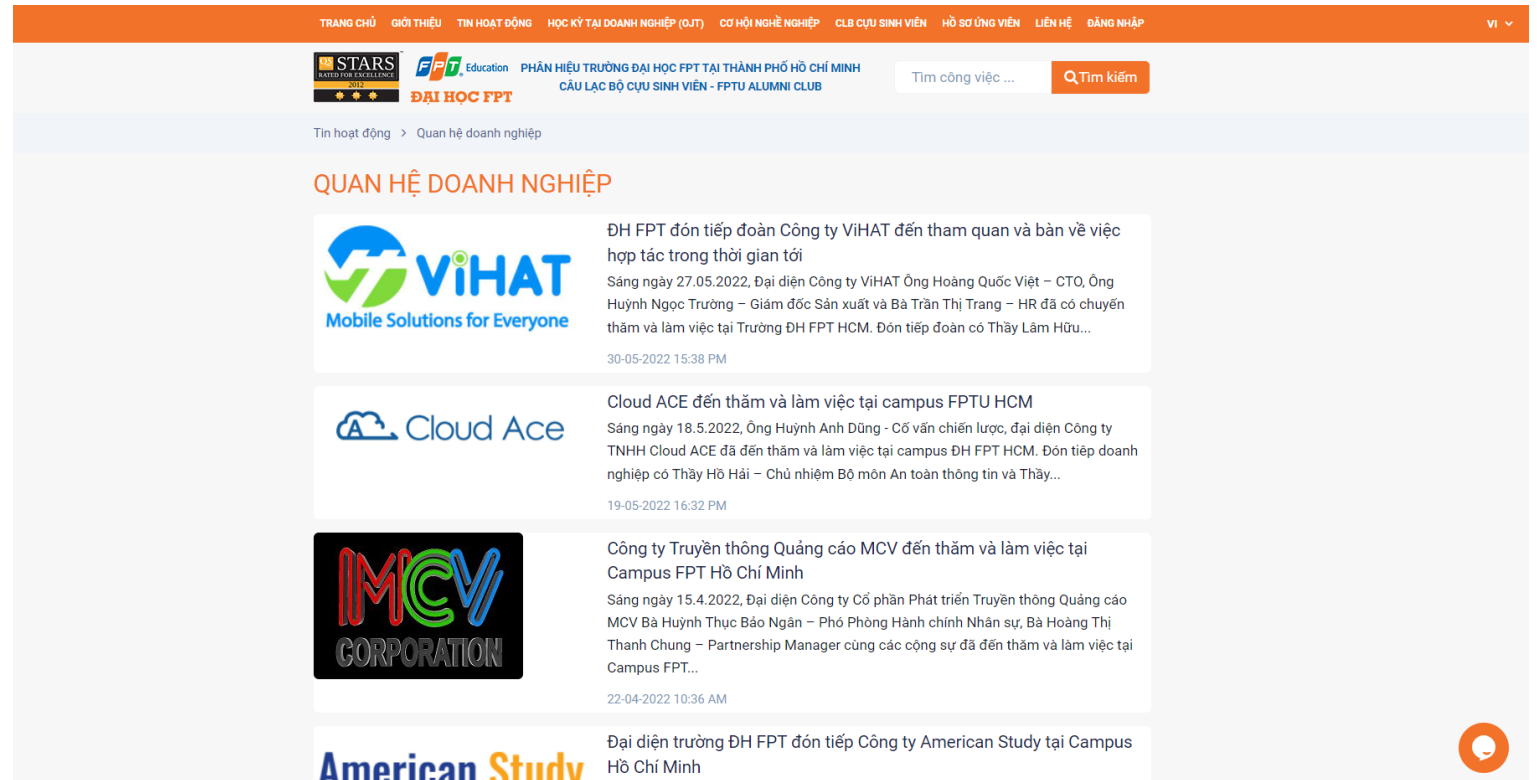


Analyzing Your Qualifications and Job Preferences

- Individual profile
 - Education
 - Experience
 - References
 - Job preferences
-

Resources for the Job Search

- Campus career centers
- Networking contacts
- The Internet



Resources for the Job Search (Cont.)

- Newspaper and journal advertisements
- Private or government employment agencies
- Web page profile
- Job/career fairs



Top 10 skills of 2025

-  Analytical thinking and innovation
-  Active learning and learning strategies
-  Complex problem-solving
-  Critical thinking and analysis
-  Creativity, originality and initiative
-  Leadership and social influence
-  Technology use, monitoring and control
-  Technology design and programming
-  Resilience, stress tolerance and flexibility
-  Reasoning, problem-solving and ideation

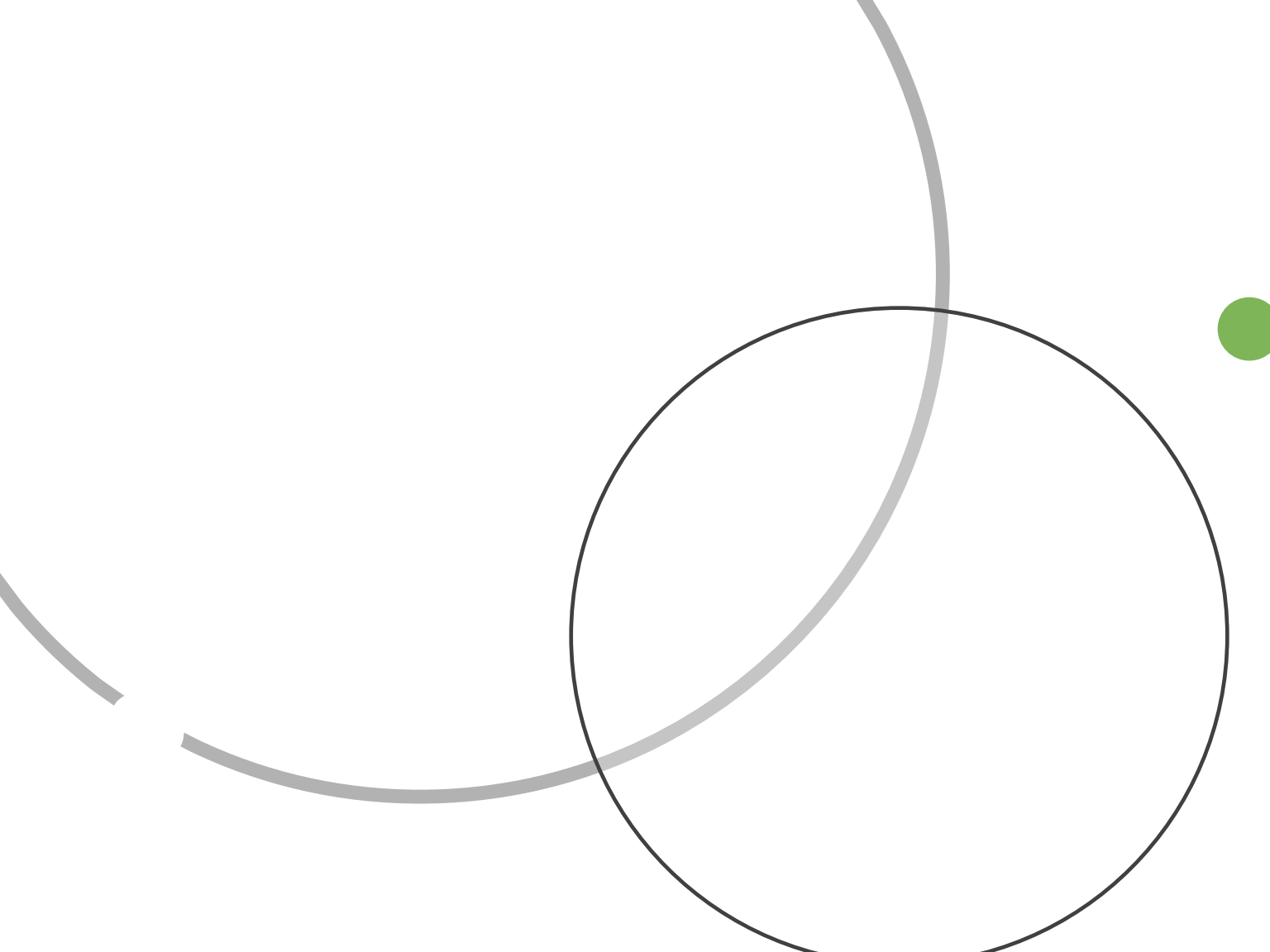
Type of skill

-  Problem-solving
-  Self-management
-  Working with people
-  Technology use and development

Source: Future of Jobs Report 2020, World Economic Forum.

Working in the post-COVID era: Top skills for the future

Source: <https://safety4sea.com/cm-working-in-the-post-covid-era-top-skills-for-the-future/>



"To address the substantial challenges facing the labour market today, governments must pursue a holistic approach, creating active linkages and coordination between education providers, skills, workers and employers, and ensuring effective collaboration between employment agencies, regional governments and national governments."



ACTIVITY: CAMPUS TO CAREER

Examine two critical questions about developing your career while still in college:

1. How do I prepare myself for a career while I'm in college?
 2. How do I position myself to get ahead?
- 

The image features a motivational quote on a rectangular card with a semi-transparent white background. The card is set against a dark background filled with out-of-focus, colorful bokeh lights in shades of blue, white, and orange. The quote is written in a black, serif font. The text reads: "Life has two rules: 1) Never quit. 2) Always remember rule #1." The card is slightly tilted and has a white border.

**“Life has two rules:
1) Never quit.
2) Always remember rule #1.”**



Résumé & Cover Letter

Session V: Career Exploration



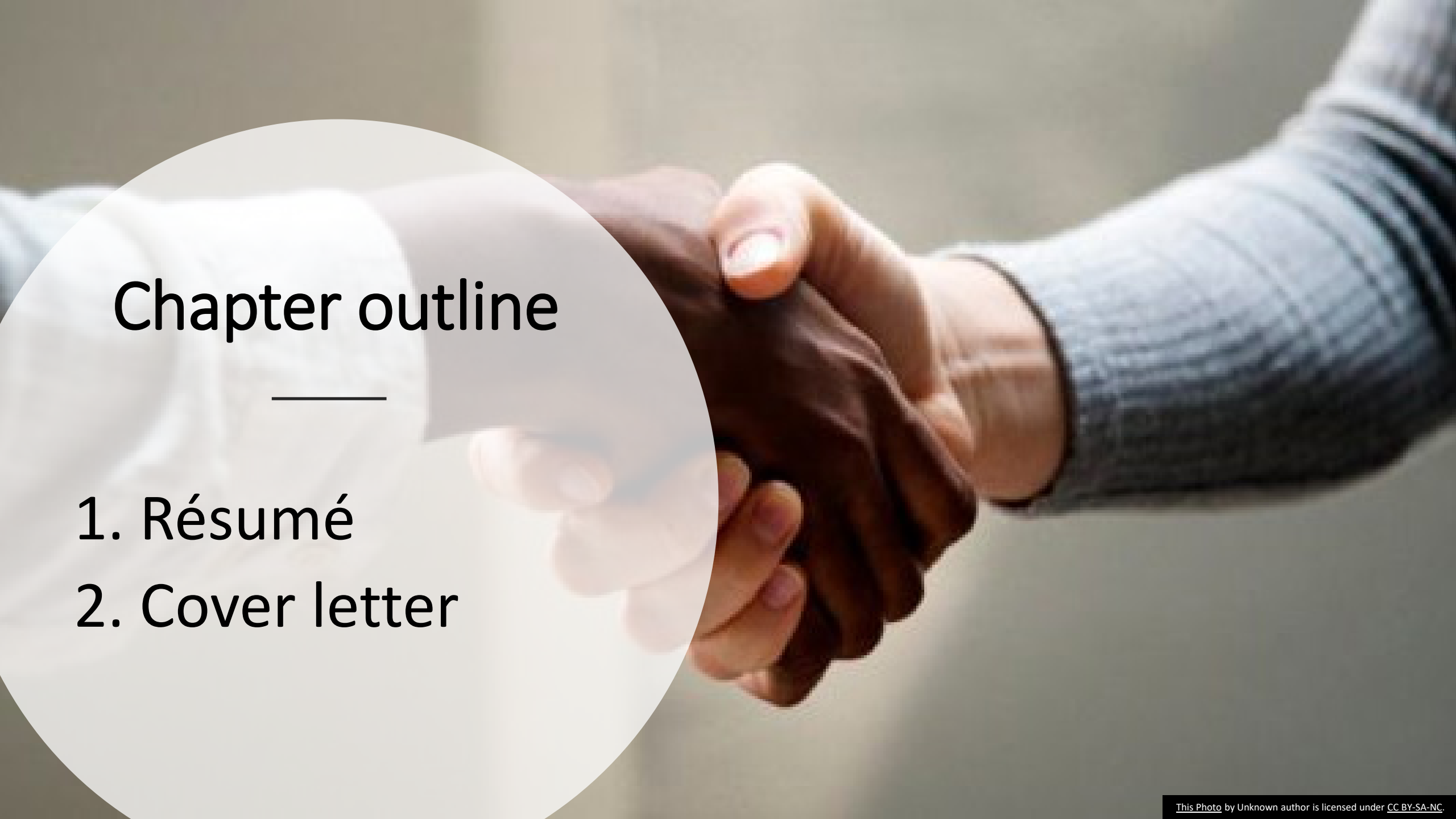


LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Define the purpose and contents of a résumé
- Identify characteristics of an effective résumé
- Identify characteristics of an effective cover letter
- Write student résumé and cover letter

Signature

Date



Chapter outline

1. Résumé
2. Cover letter

The most important
tool you have on a
résumé is language.

Jay Samit, digital media innovator



1. Résumé

The most important tool you
have on a résumé is language.

Jay Samit, digital media innovator



**MARINA
ZAMBRANO**
FRONT-END DEVELOPER

PROFILE

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas pulvinar, mi ut lacinia laoreet, massa odio elementum tellus, porta facilisis risus orci at nisi. Donec vel erat at mi tincidunt elementum sed eu felis. Nulla facilisi. Aenean fermentum convallis magna, eu mollis sapien aliquet sit amet. Aenean nec mauris tellus.

WORK EXPERIENCE

2010
2014

ENTER YOUR JOB POSITION HERE

Company Name - address here

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean enim nunc, aliquam quis odio nec, sodales cursus lorem. Integer tincidunt ultricies magna, sed lacinia metus tristique vitae.

- Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.
- Integer tincidunt ultricies magna, sed lacinia metus tristique vitae.

2010
2014

ENTER YOUR JOB POSITION HERE

Company Name - address here

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- Integer tincidunt ultricies magna, sed lacinia metus tristique vitae.

2010
2014

ENTER YOUR JOB POSITION HERE

Company Name - address here

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aenean enim nunc, aliquam quis odio nec, sodales cursus lorem. Integer tincidunt ultricies magna, sed lacinia metus tristique vitae.

- Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit.
- Integer tincidunt ultricies magna, sed lacinia metus tristique vitae.



CONTACTS



+123 45678 9000



examplemail@example.com



United States of America

EDUCATION

2016

DEGREE NAME PUT HERE

Name of University / College

2016

DEGREE NAME PUT HERE

Name of University / College

SKILLS

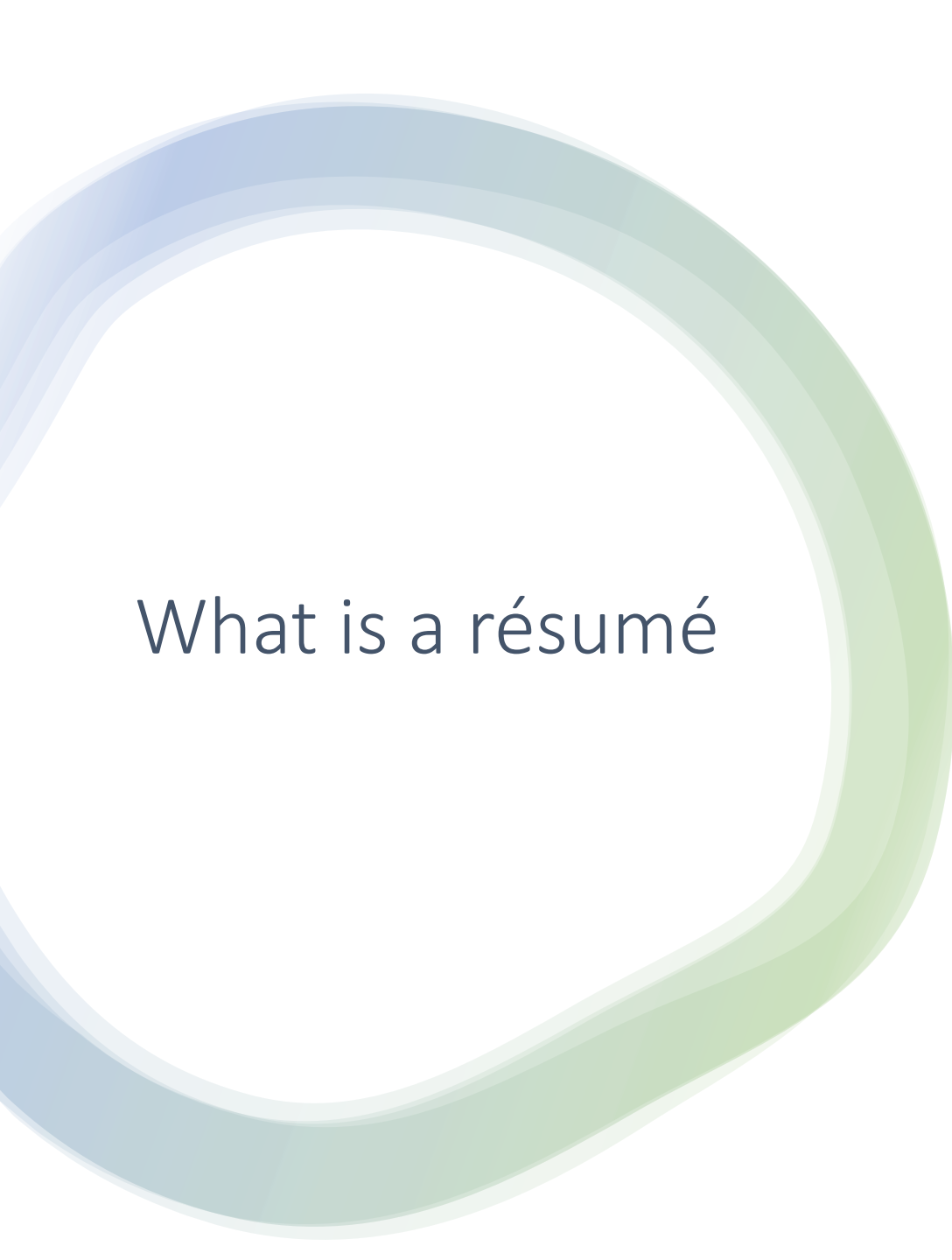
Illustrator

Photoshop

Dreamweaver

InDesign

After Effects



What is a résumé

- ❖ A résumé is a “selfie” for business purposes.
- ❖ It is a written picture of who you are—it’s a marketing tool, a selling tool, and a promotion of you as an ideal candidate for any job you may be interested in.
- ❖ The word *résumé* comes from the French word *résumé*, which means “a summary.”



Your Résumé: Purpose and Contents

- ❖ Education
- ❖ Work experience
- ❖ Job-related skills
- ❖ Accomplishments
- ❖ Volunteer history
- ❖ Internships
- ❖ Residencies, and/or more.

Elements of Your Successful Résumé

- ❖ Reverse chronological résumé
- ❖ Functional résumé
- ❖ Hybrid résumé
- ❖ Video, infographic, and Web-site résumé

Elements of Your Successful Résumé



Opening

- Heading
- Career objective
- Summary of qualifications

Education

- Most recent information first
- Name and location of each school
- Dates of attendance
- Degrees
- Major
- Achievements

Elements of Your Successful Résumé

Experience

- Dates of employment
- Job title
- Employer
- Employer's location
- Job responsibilities stated using action words and keywords

Activities/Honors/ Special Skills

- Special skills
- Computer competence
- Community service
- Published works
- Public presentations
- Military service
- Organization memberships
- Special interests

References

- Characteristics

Positive

Related to prospective job and its requirements

*Complete and easy-to-use contact information
on a separate sheet of paper*

- Who

Previous employers

Instructors (college or high school)

Avoid

- Typos –spelling mistake
- Discrimination religion, politics, gender, marital status, color, race
- Too much for the eyes
- Sensitive/non job-related photos
- Abbreviations.



Refining Your Résumé

- Print on light-colored paper with a laser printer.
- Arrange information simply but attractively.
- Use action verbs and strong phrases.
- Show a clear match between qualifications and job requirements.
- Ask for a peer review.
- Proofread carefully.
- Use a Summary of Qualifications to highlight accomplishments.

Résumé Contents and Structure

1. **Your contact information:** name, address, phone number, professional email address
2. **A summary of your skills:** 5–10 skills you have gained in your field; you can list hard skills as well as soft skills (refer to the Professional Skill Building topic in this course)
3. **Work experience:** depending on the résumé format you choose, you may list your most recent job first; include the title of the position, employer's name, location, employment dates (beginning, ending)
4. **Volunteer experience**
5. **Education and training:** formal and informal experiences matter; include academic degrees, professional development, certificates, internships, etc.
6. **References statement** (optional): “References available upon request” is a standard phrase used on résumés, although it is often implied
7. **Other sections:** may include a job objective, a brief profile, a branding statement, a summary statement, additional accomplishments, and any other related experiences



Top Ten Tips for a Successful Résumé

1. Aim to make a résumé that's 1–2 pages long on letter-size paper.
2. Make it visually appealing.
3. Use action verbs and phrases. See [Action Words and Phrases for Résumé Development](#).
4. Proofread carefully to eliminate any spelling, grammar, punctuation, and typographical errors.
5. Include highlights of your qualifications or skills to attract an employer's attention.
6. Craft your letter as a pitch to people in the profession you plan to work in.
7. Stand out as different, courageous.
8. Be positive and reflect only the truth.
9. Be excited and optimistic about your job prospects!
10. Keep refining and reworking your résumé; it's an ongoing project.



Caution

- ❖ Do not mention your age, gender, height or weight.
 - ❖ Do not include your social security number.
 - ❖ Do not mention religious beliefs or political affiliations, unless they are relevant to the position.
 - ❖ Do not include a photograph of yourself or a physical description.
 - ❖ Do not mention health issues.
 - ❖ Do not use first-person references. (I, me).
 - ❖ Do not include wage/salary expectations.
 - ❖ Do not use abbreviations.
 - ❖ Proofread carefully—absolutely no spelling mistakes are acceptable.
-



Your Résumé: It's Like Online Dating

ACTIVITY: CREATE YOUR RÉSUMÉ

Objectives:

- Compile data reflecting your professional and educational skills and accomplishments.
- Assess the main résumé formats and select one that meets your needs.
- Create a first draft of your professional résumé.

Directions:

- Compile all needed information for your résumé, including your contact information, a summary of your skills, your work experience and volunteer experience, education and training (including your intended degree, professional development activities, certificates, internships, etc.). Optionally you may wish to include job objective, a brief profile, a branding statement, additional accomplishments, and any other related experiences.
- Select one of the résumé builder tools listed above in the Résumé Writing Resources table.
- Create your résumé, following instructions at your selected site.
- Save your document as a PDF file.
- Follow instructions from your instructor on how to submit your work.

2. Cover Letter



Mauroof Ibrahim
Cyberia Smart Homes A1-7-2
Cyberjaya, 6300 Selangor
September 30, 2010

Mr. Kenny Khoo
Owner (Broadcast Media Industry)
PIXELPOST SDN BHD,
D-5-01 Block D2, Jalan PJU 8/2,
Ritze Perdana, Damansara Perdana,
47820, Petaling Jaya,
Selangor D.E. Malaysia

Dear Mr. Kenny Khoo:

Your ad for an entry-level Animator caught my attention as I prepare to begin my professional career upon graduation this spring from Limkokwing University of Creative Technology, Malaysia.

I say "professional" because I have worked steadily throughout college, gaining valuable experience that equips me to present your firm with advantages others may not offer.

As animator and concept artist or illustrator or designer for variety of events and entertainment done on commission, I acquired strong media appreciation and interpersonal skills. With this experience I am able to understand client needs and what makes a good impact on the viewers. This also aided me to make creative decisions everyone can easily understand and develop. I attained education to operate almost all well-known production softwares to kick-start any production in 2D or 3D. Dealing with the diverse concerns of students, faculty, and free-lance clientele, I have become adept at operating with the proper mix of authority, diplomacy, and tact.

While working free-lance during my studies gave me opportunities to hone my skills even further, I achieved a 3.75 cumulative grade-point average. My major, BA in Animation, provided me with a thorough foundation in principles that affect animation, production and creative media industry every day.

I would welcome the chance to discuss openings at your firm. If you will contact me at 017 383 4699, we can schedule a meeting.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

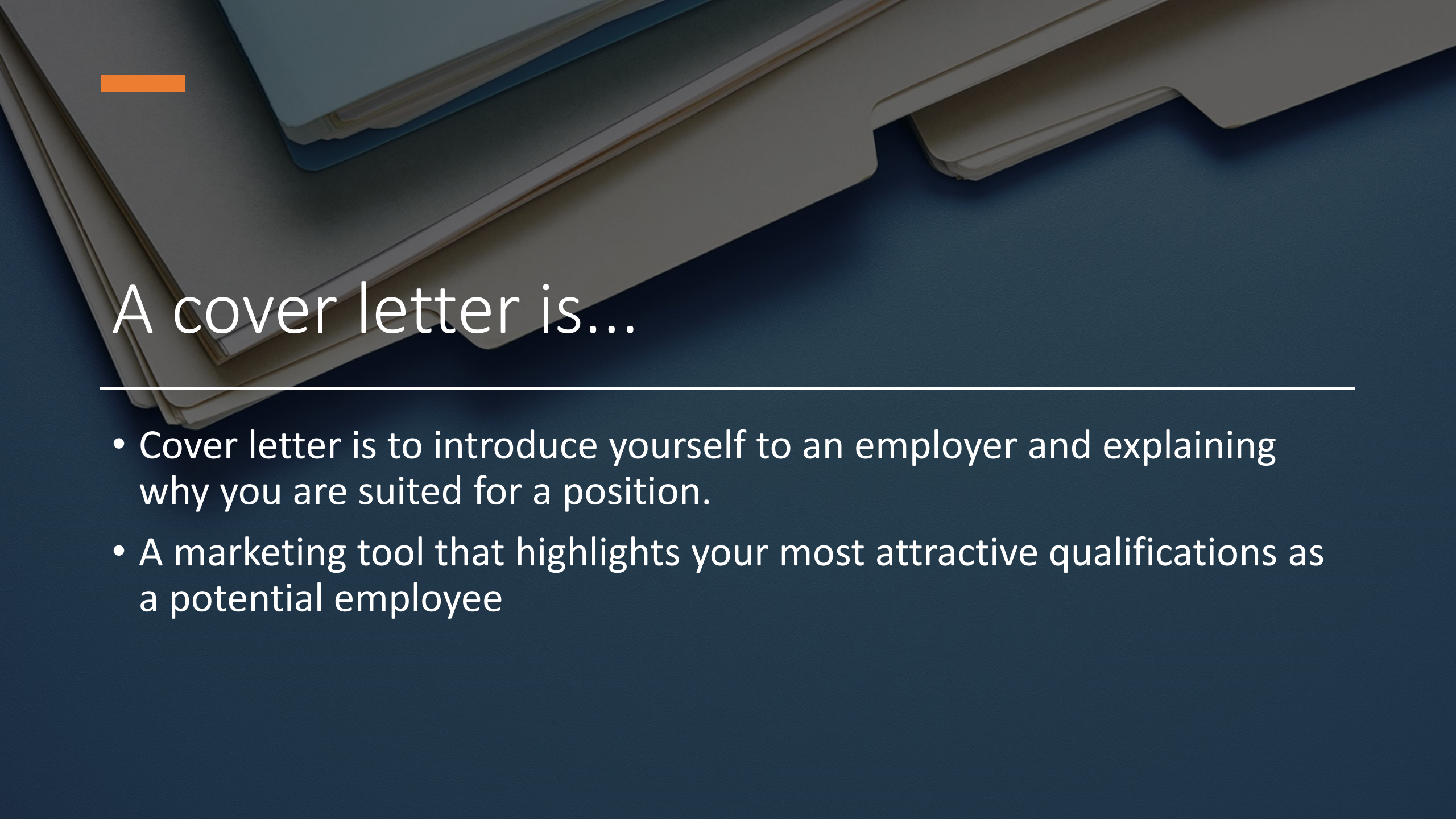
Mauroof Ibrahim
Enclosures:
1. Resume
2. Portfolio
3. Showreel (DVD)



Cover letters matter. When you have to go through a pile of them, they are probably more important than the résumé itself.

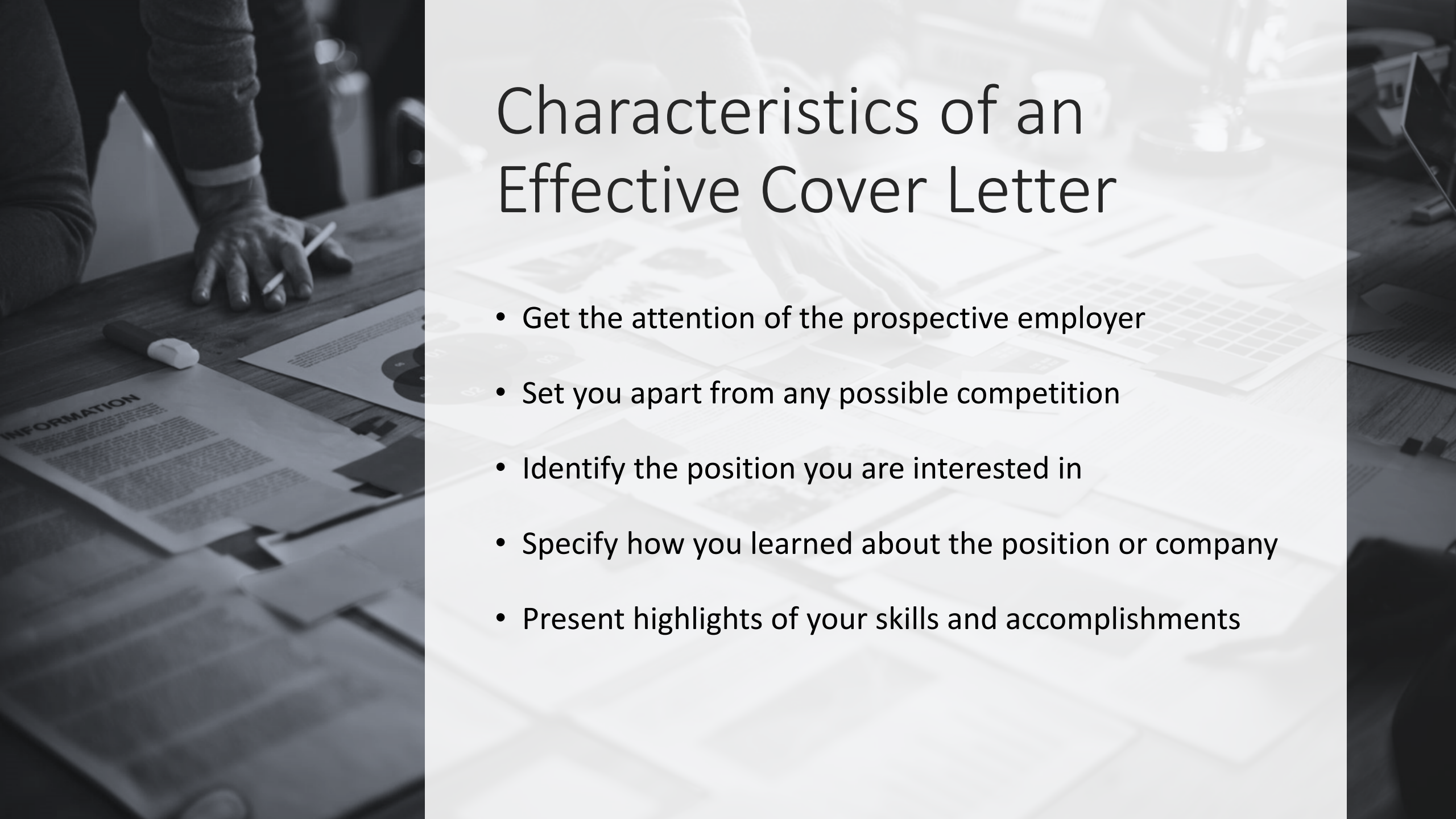
woodleywonderworks



An orange horizontal bar is located in the top left corner. The background features a stack of papers and folders in shades of blue and grey, with a dark blue textured background.

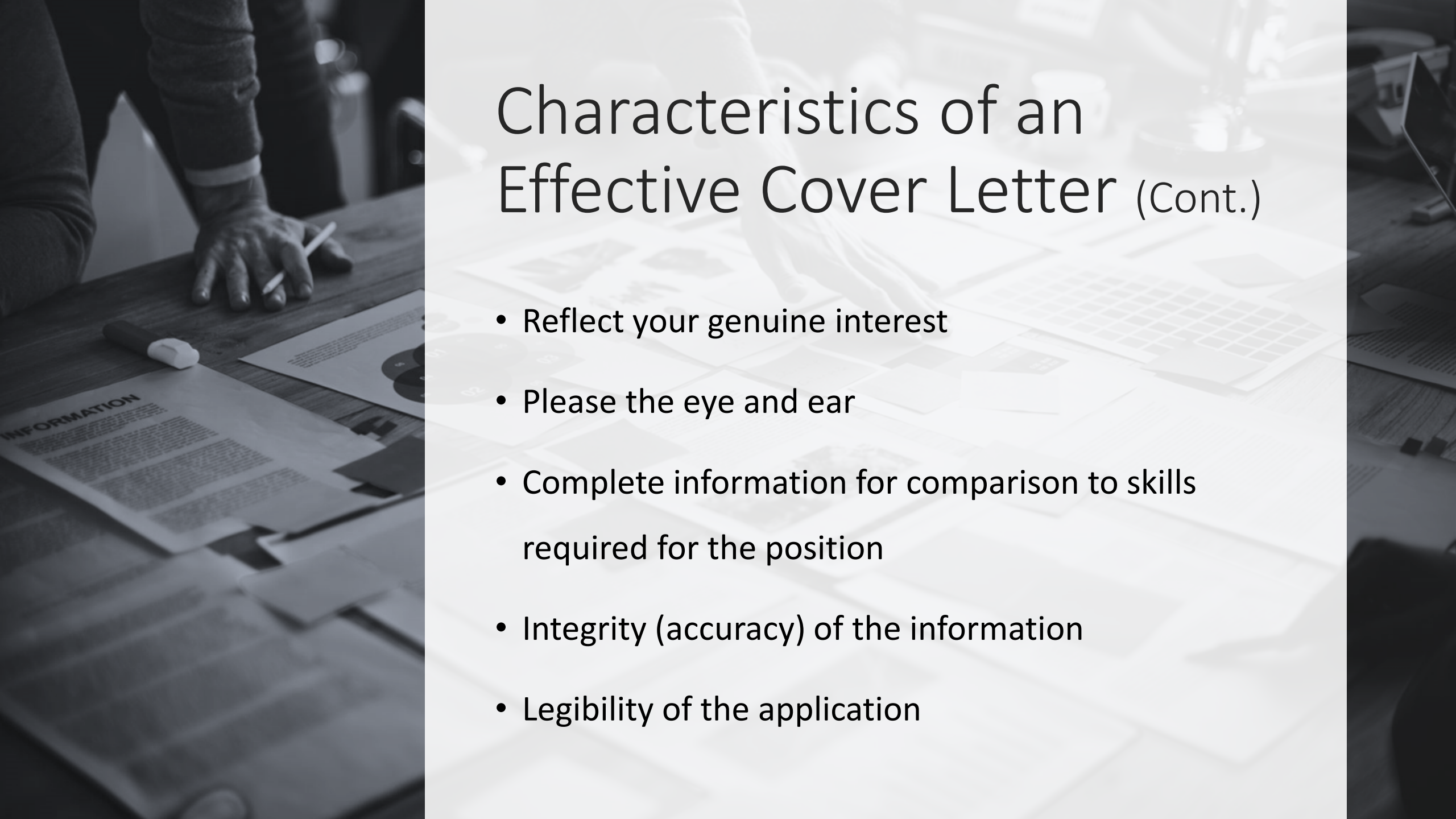
A cover letter is...

- Cover letter is to introduce yourself to an employer and explaining why you are suited for a position.
- A marketing tool that highlights your most attractive qualifications as a potential employee

A grayscale background image showing a person's hand holding a pen over a desk. The desk is cluttered with various papers, including one with the word 'INFORMATION' visible. A laptop is partially visible on the right side of the desk.

Characteristics of an Effective Cover Letter

- Get the attention of the prospective employer
- Set you apart from any possible competition
- Identify the position you are interested in
- Specify how you learned about the position or company
- Present highlights of your skills and accomplishments



Characteristics of an Effective Cover Letter (Cont.)

- Reflect your genuine interest
- Please the eye and ear
- Complete information for comparison to skills required for the position
- Integrity (accuracy) of the information
- Legibility of the application

Lucy Applicant

123 Main Street, Anytown, CA 12345 · 555-555-5555 · lucy.applicant@email.com

September 1, 2018

Eric Lee
Media Director
Kansai Collaborative Arts
123 Business Rd.
Business City, NY 54321

Dear Mr. Lee:

I am writing to you to express interest in the graphic design position as advertised on Indeed.com. As a recent graduate with experience in 3-D animation software and the Adobe suite of software, I believe I am a strong candidate for a position at Kansai Collaborative Arts.

During my time at the University of Northern State, I was awarded the top prize in the student design competition for my version of an app that would allow students to learn Japanese characters on their own time.

In addition to graduating with a 3.75 GPA, I spent a semester at a university in Japan, and I have strong conversational skills in the Japanese language. I believe this would be an asset, as I know your studio does a lot of collaborations with major design studios in Japan.

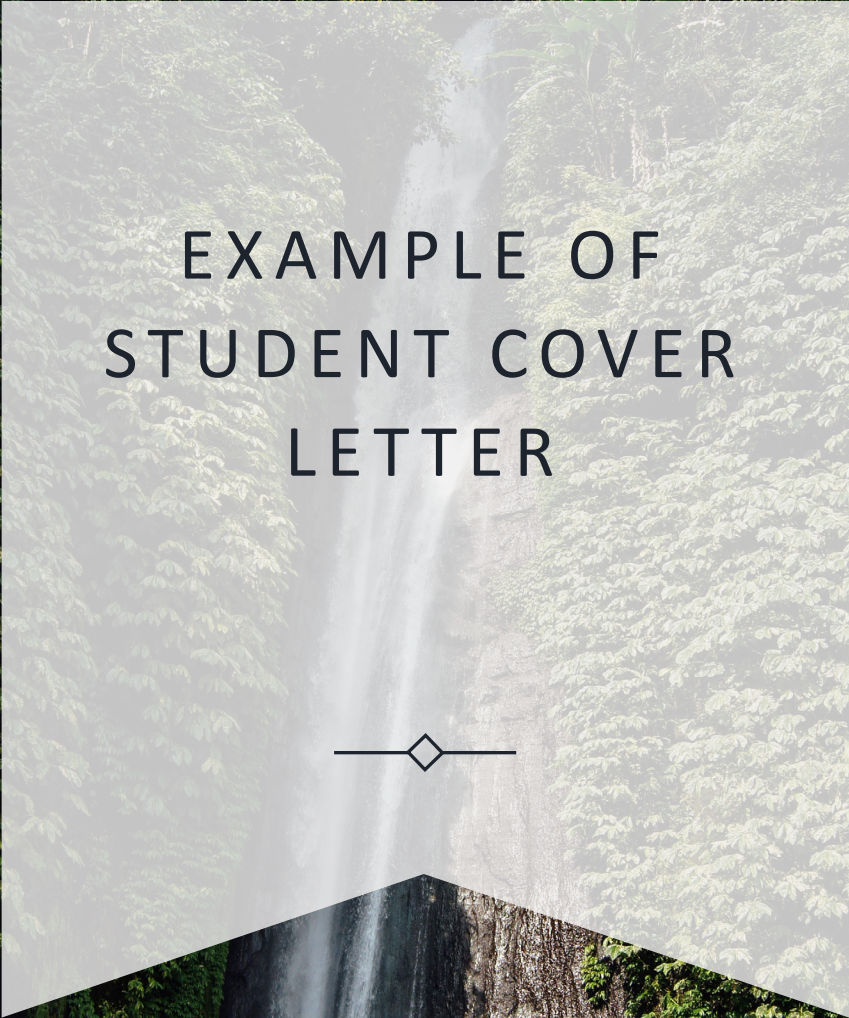
Although I am a recent college graduate, my maturity, artistic skills, ability to work with others, and knowledge of the Japanese language and culture will make me an asset for your studio.

I have enclosed my resume and will email you within the next week to see if we can arrange a time to speak further. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Lucy Applicant (signature hard copy letter)

Lucy Applicant



EXAMPLE OF STUDENT COVER LETTER



Your Name
Your Address
Your City, State Zip Code
Your Phone Number
Your Email

Date

Contact Name
Title
Company Name
Address City, State Zip Code

Dear Mr./Ms. Lastname:

I am writing to you to express interest in the graphic design position as advertised on Indeed.com. As a recent graduate with experience in 3-D animation software and the Adobe suite of software, I believe I am a strong candidate for a position at Kansai Collaborative Arts.

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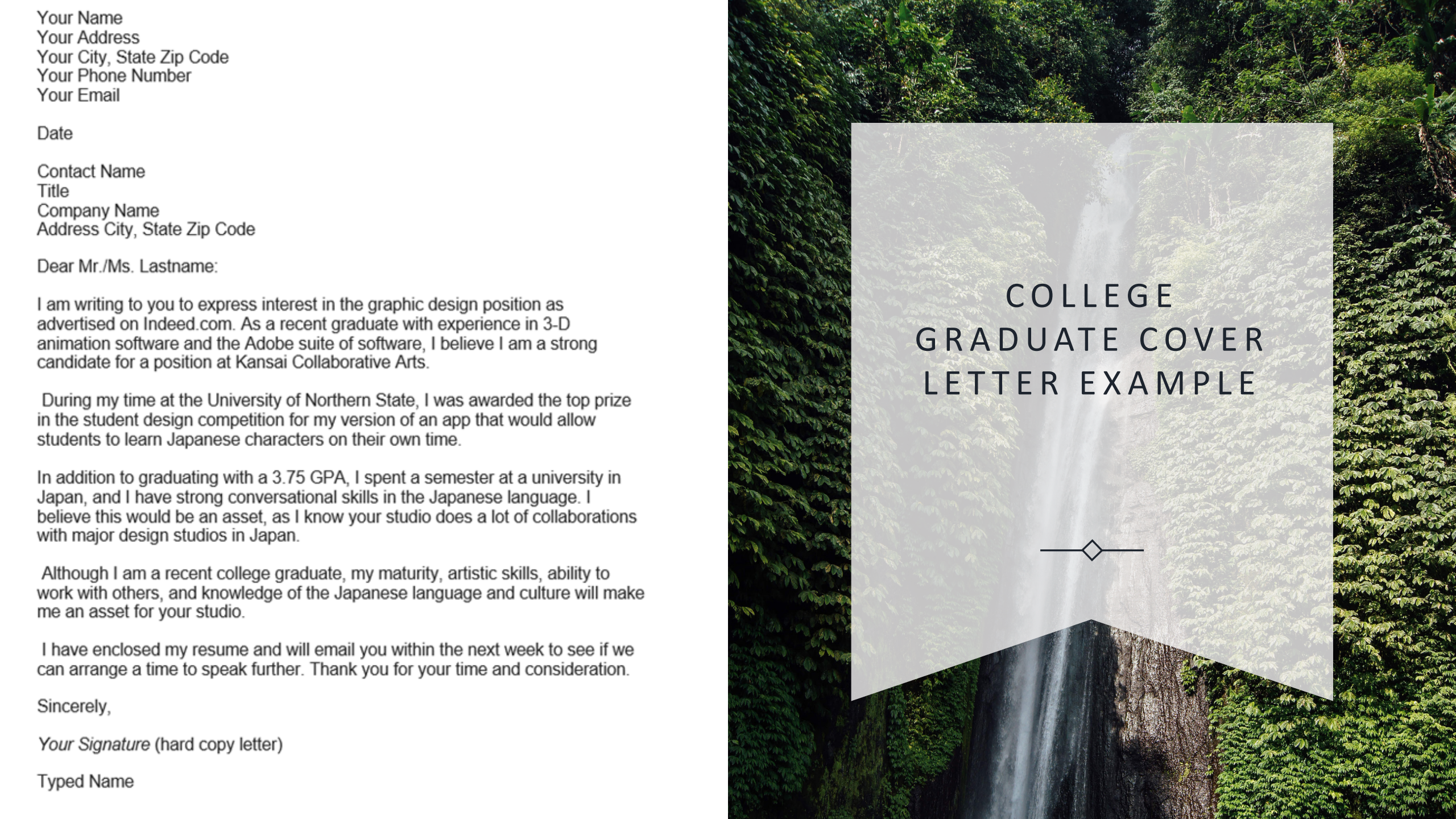
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I have enclosed my resume and will email you within the next week to see if we can arrange a time to speak further. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Your Signature (hard copy letter)

Typed Name



COLLEGE GRADUATE COVER LETTER EXAMPLE



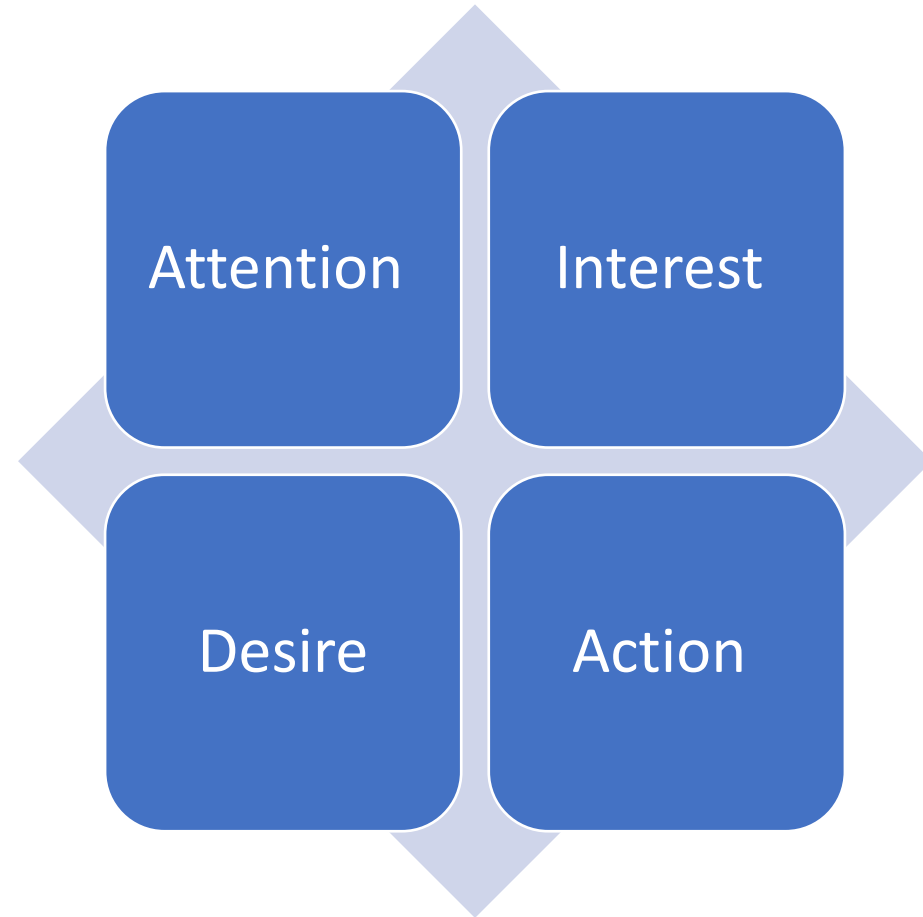


LinkedIn Cover Letter

This site contains articles, experts, jobs, and more: get all the professional insights you need on LinkedIn:

<https://www.linkedin.com/>

An Application Letter Achieves:



An Application Letter Achieves:

Attention

- Gain favorable attention.
- Express interest in the position.
- Motivate the receiver to read the entire application letter.

Interest

- Market your qualifications
- Identify special strengths and attributes and relate how they meet job requirements.

An Application Letter Achieves:

Desire

- Describe selected accomplishments that show how you can benefit the company.
- Motivate the receiver to look closely at your résumé.

Action

- Request an interview or propose a future meeting.
- Provide easy-to-use contact information.
- Suggest scheduling alternatives.

Anatomy of a Cover Letter

A basic formula for cover letters is as follows:

- **Standard business letter address format**—prospect name, title, company, address—top left
- **Salutation** (yes, it should be to a real person—take time to know your target)
- **First paragraph**—why you are writing? To meet that company's specific need(s)!
- **Second paragraph**—briefly state two or three top skills (from the Summary section of your resume), then immediately follow with the benefits these features (and you as a person) will provide to the company.
- **Third paragraph**—close! Not just the ending of the letter, but the "sales closer" to the letter. Close the sale. Give your target contact a specific action to take and a backup action you will take if you do not get a response.

Anatomy of a Cover Letter

A basic formula for cover letters is as follows:

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Activity

- Write a cover letter, think about where you want to work, the job you really enjoy and are capable of.
- Draft and finalize your cover letter and share it with your classmates.

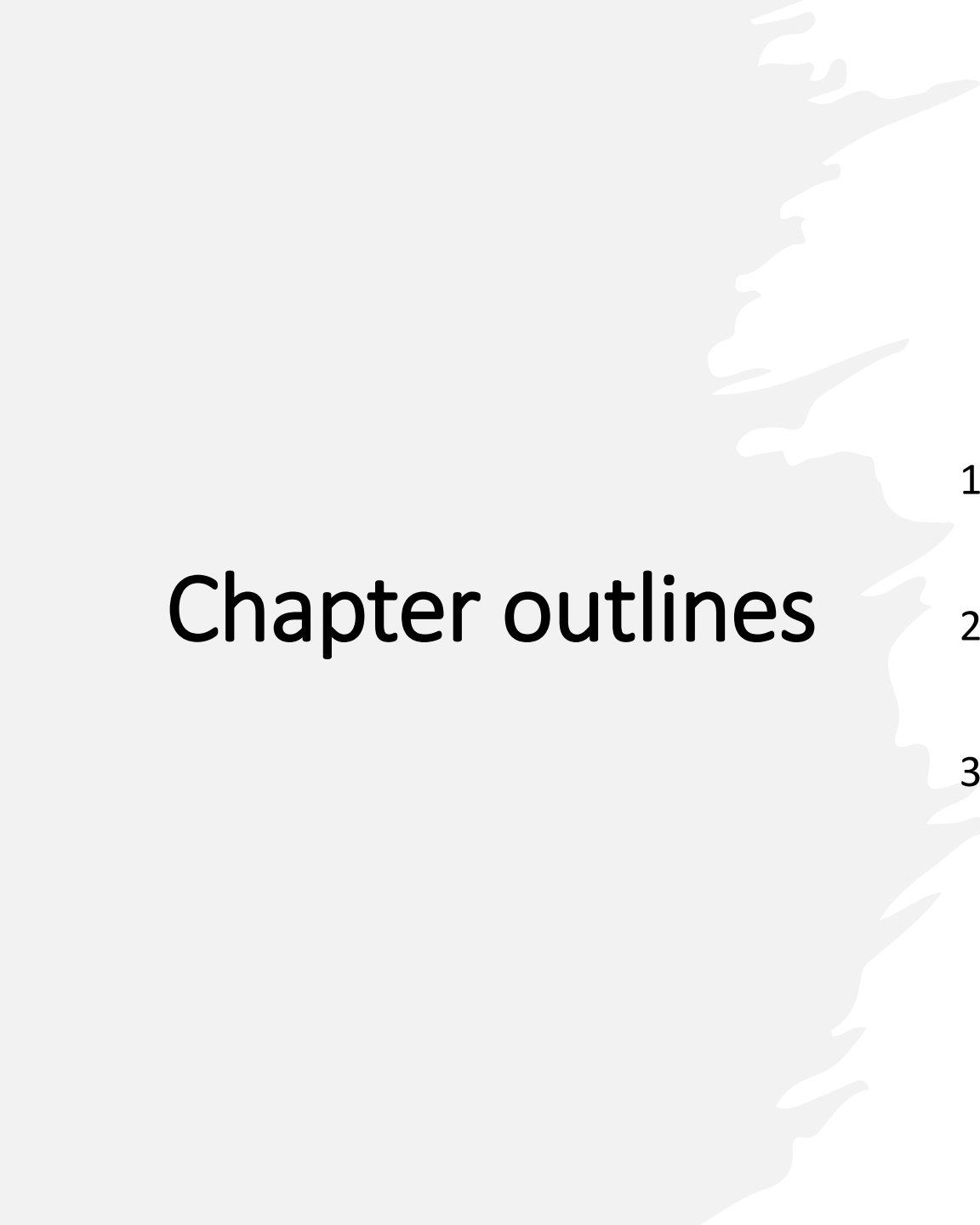




Job Interview Preparation

SESSION V: CAREER
EXPLORATION





Chapter outlines

1. Preparing Effectively for a Job Interview
2. Job Interview Types and Techniques
3. Interview Questions

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

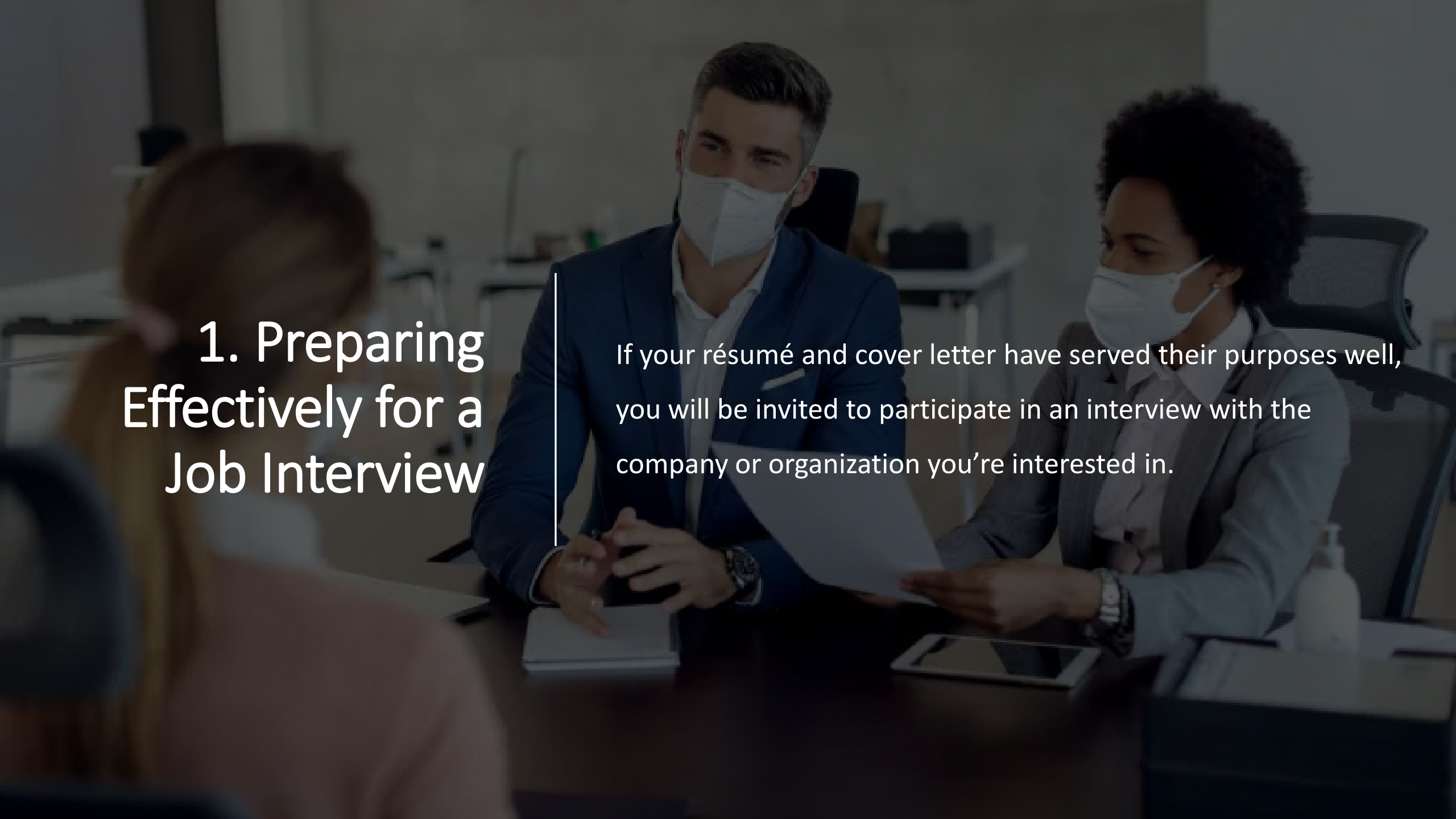
By the end of this section, you will be able to:

- Describe effective strategies to prepare for an interview
- Differentiate between different types of interview situations and identify appropriate interview techniques for each
- Analyze different question types common in interviews



One important key to success is
self-confidence. An important
key to self-confidence is
preparation.

Arthur Ashe, champion tennis player



1. Preparing Effectively for a Job Interview

If your résumé and cover letter have served their purposes well, you will be invited to participate in an interview with the company or organization you're interested in.

Interviewing for a Job

Preparation

Participation

Types of interviews

Steps for preparing effectively for a job interview

- Review the Job Description
- Research the Company or Organization
- Practice Answering Common Questions
- Plan to Dress Appropriately
- Come Prepared
- Be Confident



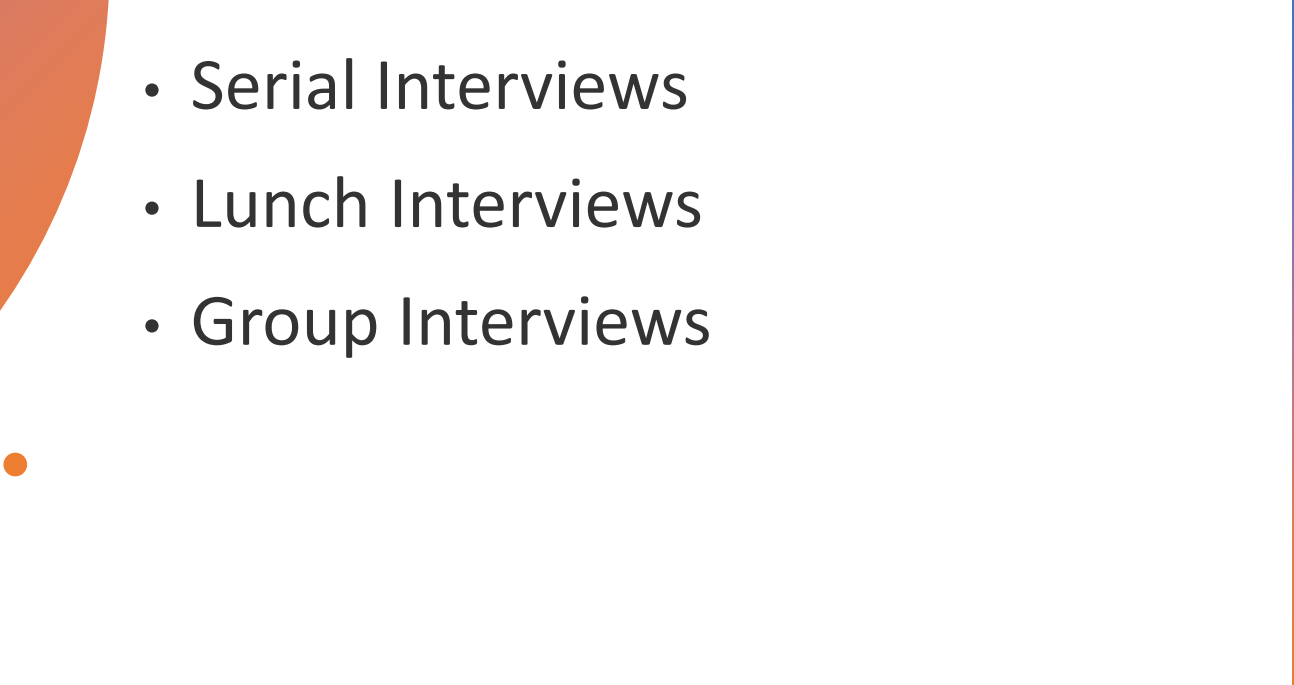


Participating in an Interview

- Greet the interviewer.
- Shake hands.
- Sit when asked.
- Respond in a businesslike manner.
- Maintain eye contact.
- Be alert to signals the interview is ending.
- Express appreciation for the time.
- Ask when you will receive notice of the decision.
- Shake hands.



2. Job Interview Types and Techniques

- Screening Interviews
 - Phone or Web Conference Interviews
 - One-on-One Interviews
 - Panel Interviews
 - Serial Interviews
 - Lunch Interviews
 - Group Interviews
- 

ACTIVITY:
**WHAT
MAKES YOU
A GREAT
FIT?**

Answer the below questions:

1. What is your job title and what are you responsible for executing?
 2. What is the name of the company or organization? What is its function?
 3. Identify the top three reasons why you are a great fit for this job.
 4. What sets you apart from the competition?
 5. List the qualities, skills and values you have that match the job requirements. Provide examples to support your answers. Connect your values to the company's values.
- 

3. Interview Questions

- Know the common interview questions to expect, and understand the intention behind each
- Strategically craft a great answer for each question
- Practice interviewing until you're as strong as possible



Be ready to
answer questions:



- Traditional questions
- Behavioral interview questions
- Unacceptable questions

Traditional questions

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. What is your greatest strength?
your greatest weakness?
3. Tell me about your course work.
What courses did you like best?
least?
4. Tell me about your
extracurricular activities while
you were in school.
5. What job-related skills have you
developed that are crucial to
this job?



Behavioral questions

1. What major problem have you faced in group projects and how have you dealt with it?
2. Describe a situation in which you were successful (or unsuccessful) in motivating someone.
3. Describe a situation at work or at school where you took the initiative. What was the result? How did you feel?
4. Describe the most difficult person with whom you have worked. How did you handle the situation?
5. Give me an example of a time management skill you've learned and how you applied it at school or at work.



Unacceptable questions

1. You don't look like a native of this country. Where were you born?
2. Do you have any disabilities?
3. Where do you attend church?
4. Do you have adequate child care? Who will look after your children while you work?



Discussion: How to Answer

1. "Tell Me About Yourself"
2. Describe Your Current (or Most Recent) Position"
3. "Why are you looking for a new opportunity now?"
4. "What are your strengths?"
5. "What is your greatest weakness?"
6. "Why do you want to work here?"
7. "Where do you see yourself in five years?"
8. "Why should we hire you?"
9. "Do you have any questions for me?"

Purpose of Other Employment Communication

- Following up on an application
- Accepting an interview invitation
- Following up an interview
- Accepting employment
- Rejecting employment
- Expressing appreciation to references and others
- Resigning from a job

Key Takeaway

- Use simple, clear, and direct language; get to the point immediately.
- Focus on the employer's needs.
- Maintain a balance between professionalism and friendliness.
- Demonstrate enthusiasm and confidence, but don't be presumptuous.

